

20 prompts for finance professionals and founders

20
PROMPTS

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4 AI
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USD

Finance

Works with: **ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • Llama**

About This Playbook

20 expert prompts for finance teams and founders building models and communicating financial data.

What You'll Get

• 20 expert prompts • Professional frameworks • Placeholder system • Expert tips per prompt

Who It's For

• Entrepreneurs • Professionals • Teams • Freelancers

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 Copy the prompt — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 Fill in the brackets — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 Paste & generate — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 Iterate — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

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Section 1

Section 1 (4 prompts)

Prompt #01

Three-Statement Financial Model

Build a 3-statement financial model for [BUSINESS] over [PERIOD].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a 3-statement financial model for [BUSINESS] over [PERIOD]. Deliver: Revenue model, P&L with detailed line items, Balance sheet drivers, Cash flow statement, Key assumptions tab

■ **Tip:** Document every assumption. The model is only as credible as the assumptions behind it.

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Prompt #02

Startup Financial Model

Build a startup financial model for [STARTUP] raising [ROUND].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a startup financial model for [STARTUP] raising [ROUND]. Deliver: Revenue drivers (not just 'assume X% growth'), Cost structure, Hiring plan, Cash runway, Break-even analysis, Funding scenarios

■ **Tip:** Investors look for coherent unit economics, not pretty spreadsheets.

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Prompt #03

Revenue Forecasting Methods

Apply multiple revenue forecasting methods for [BUSINESS].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Apply multiple revenue forecasting methods for [BUSINESS]. Deliver: Top-down market sizing, Bottom-up pipeline/capacity, Historical trend, Driver-based For each: When to use + how to build

■ **Tip:** Use multiple methods and triangulate. If they diverge wildly, find out why.

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Prompt #04

Scenario Modeling Framework

Build a scenario analysis for [BUSINESS DECISION] with 3 scenarios.

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a scenario analysis for [BUSINESS DECISION] with 3 scenarios. Deliver: Base, Bull, Bear cases with different assumptions For each: Key differences in assumptions + financial outcomes + probability-weighted result

■ **Tip:** Scenario analysis is most valuable when it shows which assumptions matter most.

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Section 2

Section 2 (4 prompts)

Prompt #05

SaaS Financial Model

Build a SaaS financial model for [SAAS COMPANY].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a SaaS financial model for [SAAS COMPANY]. Deliver: MRR/ARR build, Churn model, CAC and LTV by segment, Operating leverage, Cohort revenue retention, Rule of 40

■ **Tip:** SaaS models built on cohort assumptions are more accurate than those built on averages.

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Prompt #06

Cash Flow Forecasting

Build a 13-week cash flow forecast for [COMPANY].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a 13-week cash flow forecast for [COMPANY]. Deliver: Operating cash flows (AR/AP timing), Payroll schedule, Capital expenditures, Debt service Weekly cash position

■ **Tip:** 13-week cash forecasts catch liquidity problems before they become crises.

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Prompt #07

Investor Presentation Financial Section

Build the financial section of [COMPANY]'s investor presentation.

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build the financial section of [COMPANY]'s investor presentation. Deliver: Historical performance (3 years or all years), Current year projection, 3-year model, Key metrics dashboard, Use of funds

■ **Tip:** Investors trust models that show conservative assumptions with clear upside scenarios.

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Prompt #08

Budget vs Actual Variance Analysis

Design a budget vs actual reporting system for [COMPANY].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Design a budget vs actual reporting system for [COMPANY]. Deliver: Monthly variance template, Significant variance threshold, Commentary format, Management reporting package, Reforecast cadence

■ **Tip:** Variance analysis that explains the WHY is management information. The WHAT is just accounting.

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Section 3

Section 3 (4 prompts)

Prompt #09

Unit Economics Model

Calculate unit economics for [BUSINESS MODEL].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Calculate unit economics for [BUSINESS MODEL]. Deliver: CAC, LTV, Payback period, Gross margin by product, Contribution margin, Break-even by cohort

■ **Tip:** Unit economics that don't work at small scale rarely work at large scale.

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Prompt #10

Real Estate Financial Model

Build a financial model for [REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a financial model for [REAL ESTATE INVESTMENT]. Deliver: Acquisition cost, Renovation budget, Stabilized NOI, Cap rate valuation, Debt structure, Cash-on-cash, IRR

■ **Tip:** Real estate models are only as good as your rent and vacancy assumptions.

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Prompt #11

E-commerce Financial Model

Build an e-commerce financial model for [ONLINE STORE].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build an e-commerce financial model for [ONLINE STORE]. Deliver: Revenue by channel, COGS and gross margin, CAC by channel, LTV by cohort, Working capital (inventory) model

■ **Tip:** E-commerce models must model inventory financing separately from operating cash flow.

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Prompt #12

Fundraising Financial Model

Build a fundraising model for [STARTUP] raising [AMOUNT].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a fundraising model for [STARTUP] raising [AMOUNT]. Deliver: Use of funds, Milestone-to-milestone burn, Post-money valuation scenarios, Dilution model, Next round triggers

■ **Tip:** Model 24 months of runway post-raise. Investors want to see the path to the next milestone.

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Section 4

Section 4 (4 prompts)

Prompt #13

Sensitivity Analysis

Build a sensitivity analysis for [KEY BUSINESS ASSUMPTION] at [COMPANY]

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a sensitivity analysis for [KEY BUSINESS ASSUMPTION] at [COMPANY]. Deliver: Variable identification, Range selection, Data table design, Output visualization, Implications summary

■ **Tip:** Sensitivity analysis answers: 'Which assumption do I need to be most right about?'

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Prompt #14

Financial Ratio Analysis

Analyze the financial health of [COMPANY] using key ratios.

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Analyze the financial health of [COMPANY] using key ratios. Deliver: Liquidity, Profitability, Efficiency, Leverage, Growth For each ratio: Formula + calculation + benchmarks + interpretation

■ **Tip:** Financial ratios only make sense in context. Compare to industry benchmarks and historical trends.

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Prompt #15

Private Equity Return Model

Model private equity returns for [INVESTMENT] with [INVESTMENT THESIS]

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Model private equity returns for [INVESTMENT] with [INVESTMENT THESIS]. Deliver: Entry multiple, Revenue/EBITDA growth, Exit multiple, Debt paydown, Equity value, MOIC and IRR

■ **Tip:** Private equity returns are made at entry. The purchase price matters more than the operational improvement.

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Prompt #16

Working Capital Optimization

Analyze and optimize working capital for [COMPANY].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Analyze and optimize working capital for [COMPANY]. Deliver: DSO, DPO, DIO analysis Working capital cycle calculation Improvement opportunities (AR, AP, inventory) Cash conversion cycle target

■ **Tip:** Working capital optimization is often a faster path to cash than raising more equity.

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Section 5

Section 5 (4 prompts)

Prompt #17

Break-Even Analysis

Calculate break-even for [PRODUCT/BUSINESS] at [PRICE POINT].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Calculate break-even for [PRODUCT/BUSINESS] at [PRICE POINT]. Deliver: Fixed costs, Variable costs, Contribution margin, Break-even units and revenue, Margin of safety, Price sensitivity analysis

■ **Tip:** Break-even analysis answers: 'How many do I need to sell to justify the fixed cost?'

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Prompt #18

Capital Allocation Framework

Build a capital allocation framework for [COMPANY] with [\$AVAILABLE CA

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a capital allocation framework for [COMPANY] with [\$AVAILABLE CAPITAL]. Deliver: Investment categories, Hurdle rates by category, NPV/IRR analysis, Portfolio diversification, Strategic vs financial return trade-offs

■ **Tip:** Companies that explicitly manage capital allocation generate 30% higher shareholder returns on average.

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Prompt #19

Acquisition Financial Model

Build a financial model for [COMPANY]'s acquisition of [TARGET].

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Build a financial model for [COMPANY]'s acquisition of [TARGET]. Deliver: Standalone value of target, Synergy model, Pro forma combined, Purchase price scenarios, Accretion/dilution analysis, Integration costs

■ **Tip:** Acquisition models that overestimate synergies destroy value. Be conservative on synergies.

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Claude ✓

Gemini ✓

Prompt #20

CFO Dashboard Design

Design a CFO dashboard for [COMPANY] covering financial health.

You are a CFO and financial modeling expert. Design a CFO dashboard for [COMPANY] covering financial health. Deliver: Cash runway, Revenue performance, Expense management, Working capital, Metrics vs budget, Key alerts

■ **Tip:** CFO dashboards should answer three questions: Do we have enough cash? Are we growing? Are costs under control?

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